

May 2012 Issue

Janhit Foundation's E-Newsletter



From the Director's Desk

The past six months have again been a hectic one for all associated with Janhit Foundation. I am pleased to announce that we have successfully completed an 18 month agricultural project with the Oxfam Trust. During this period we have successfully overseen the introduction of organic aromatic plant cultivation in the fields of 800 farmers in Western Uttar Pradesh.

I am also delighted to confirm our ongoing partnerships with Coca Cola India and the Charities Aid Foundation (CAF), whom continue to support our water conservation work, currently taking the medium of the restoration of natural ponds in the region.

Most importantly, I would like to thank our partners for their ongoing trust and support, especially the CHILDLINE Foundation, who continue to support us in the implementation of the Meerut CHILDLINE Service.



Anita Rana

Our Family

Anita Rana	Director
Devpal Singh	Senior Prog. Coordinator
Ravindra Kumar	Asst. Prog. Coordinator
Jitendra Kumar	Asst. Prog. Coordinator
Sangeeta	Organic Aaharam Manager
Rajat Saini	Accountant
Surbhi Rastogi	Administrative Incharge
Sonakshi Nitin Yadav	Freelancer

Pradeep Kumar	Chief Coordinator
Rohit Kumar	Asst. Prog. Coordinator
Ravindra Singh	Asst. Prog. Coordinator
Deshraj Singh	Asst. Prog. Coordinator
Deepak Garg	Chartered Accountant
Arun Bansal	Accountant

CHILDLINE TRAM

Ayushi Rastogi	Cooordinator	Neelam Srivastava	Para-Professional
Sangeeta	Team Member	Anil Kumar	Team Mamber
Ran Singh	Team Member	Satendra Kumar	Team Member
Mahesh Kumar	Team Member	Mammohan Singh	Team Member
Shivesh Mukherjee	Team Member	Shivani Chaudhary	Volunteer
Kavita Sharma	Volunteer	Avnish Sharma	Volunteer

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WORLD WATER WEEK



Inter-College Debate Competition at Deewan VS Institute of Engineering and Technology, Meerut & Radha Govind Engineering College, Greater NOIDA

An Inter college debate competition was organized at Greater NOIDA and Meerut on March 21 and 22 respectively.

In Greater NOIDA, the event was celebrated at Radha Govind College and in Meerut it was hosted by Deewan VS Institute of Engineering. Both the events were participated in by 16 teams from various colleges. The topic of the debate was 'Water should be considered a National Property' and the students shared their views of ownership and non-ownership of water resources as a National property.

The guests at Radha Govind College were Mr. Sanjay Rana (Director, Aqua Foundation) and Ms. Veena Khanduri (Executive Secretary, IWP).

The chief guests at the function in Meerut was Ms. Madhu Gujjar (Mayor – Meerut) and the other honored guests were Ms. Veena Khanduri (Executive Secretary, IWP), Mr. Prabhat Roy (Retd. PCS Officer), Ms. Anvita Aggarwal (Professor – R G College, Meerut), Dr. Sanjeev Kaushik (Director – Deewan College), Dr. Vineet Kumar (Deen – Deewan College), Dr. P. K. Aggarwal (Director – Deewan Management College) were also present at the event as special guests.

Eco-club of Deewan College also showed an active participation in the competition. MIET, Meerut ranked first; IIMT ranked second and Deewan institute came third in the debate. The winners were awarded with a trophy and all the participants were given a certificate.

Debate and Speech Competition

On March 23, 2012 a drawing and speech competition was organized at Kasturba Gandhi Residential School, Poorva Ahiran, Meerut. Around 200 students participated in the competition and painted on the topic 'Clean water for a better health' and shared their views on the topic 'Importance of safe water quality for a good health'.

Guests on the occasion were Mr. Prabhat Roy (Retd. PCS Officer), Mr. Gajendar Singh (BSA – Meerut) and Mr. Nimish Jar (Nagar Shiksha Adhikari).

Three best drawings and speeches were awarded with a certificate and a medal. Other participants were awarded with a participation certificate.

Likewise every year, World Water Day was celebrated by Janhit Foundation. This year we joined hands with FANSA & India Water Partnership. The following activities have been organized on the occasion -

Awareness Programme

100 women and children living in the slum communities of Meerut were educated on 'Water and sanitation cleanliness' by Janhit Foundation in association with the local Anganwadi group on March 23, 2012. An interactive discussion was held with the community and a documentary was screened in order to create make the message far reaching.

Poster Making Competition

An Inter College Poster Making and Slogan Writing Competition was organised on 24th March 2012 at Radha Govind Engineering College, Meerut, with an aim to spark the thought process of the children on safe sanitation and water.

The topic of the competition was 'Proper Sanitation and Safe Water'. The best drawings were chosen and awarded on the basis of good depiction of the topic, portrayal and practicality of the idea and innovation of a good slogan. The winners were awarded with a trophy, medal and a certificate. Other participants were also given a participation certificate.

Eco San Walk

With the aim to promote better sanitation and water practices amongst the Meerutians, an eco-san walk was organized which involved participation of school and college students, NGOs, Social leaders and media people. This walk was organized in association with the CCS University, Meerut in their campus.

**EVERYTHING ORIGINATES
IN**

'WATER'

**AND EVERYTHING IS SUS-
TAINED BY**

'WATER'



Urban RWH Training Programme

Mr. Sandeep Kumar who is presently managing the rainwater harvesting projects at Janhit Foundation participated in the Urban Rain Water Harvesting training program conducted by Centre for Science and Environment, New Delhi. The training programme was participated in by civil engineers, architects, urban planners, environment consultants and other NGOs, students and academicians. Through the programme, the participants gained knowledge, acquired holistic perspectives and got hands-on practice in planning and designing urban water harvesting systems.

Candle March to mark 'Earth Hour'

Earth Hour is a worldwide event organized by the World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF) and is held on the last Saturday of March annually, encouraging households and businesses to turn off their non-essential lights for one hour to raise awareness about the need to take action on climate change.

A candle march was organized by Janhit Foundation starting from Rangoli Mandap to Nai sadak locality of Shastri Nagar where more than two hundred citizens of Meerut lit up candles to observe Earth Hour, as a show of solidarity with people across the globe, for combating with all the environmental problems.



Children learn to measure Earth's circumference

On 21/3/12, Meerut CHILDLINE Team in association with Mr. Deepak Kumar of N.A.S. Inter college organized an activity of Measuring the circumference of the Earth for the slum children. Mr. Deepak Kumar directed the children on how to perform the tests & measure the Earth's circumference. In this test, the children tried to measure the circumference with the help of a pole & also gained some knowledge on how to locate directions. Mr. Deepak informed that this test is being conducted with the help of children from all over the world. He told that the circumference of earth is reducing by 6 cm every year along with rise in earth's temperature which is a serious matter. He told that the correct time for calculating the circumference of earth in India is from 11:30 am to 12:30 pm. Around 15-20 children participated in this program.

Support Acknowledgement

Janhit Foundation thanks all the volunteers and interns who supported and helped in the execution of the activities mentioned in this newsletter. Your association with us was a great experience for the foundation too and was very valuable for us.

'Best Wishes for the Future'.

Give as You Earn Programme

Medical Assistance through free check up camps

Jaibheem Nagar in Meerut city has a population of over 10,000 mainly comprising of slum dwellers who are economically, socially marginalized and are a part of schedule caste community. The slum is sandwiched between LLRM Medical College on one end which discharges its untreated toxic wastes in the water supplies and on the other side with the highly polluted Kali River (East). There is a gross violation of Human Right to Water of the residents living here compounded by a complete lack of basic medical facilities to help the sick and dying.

The population of Jaibheem Nagar had been reporting an alarming rise in serious ailments and increased death rate over the last decade. The drinking water sources available to the population were failing to meet the National and International standards for safe drinking water due to contamination with a range of toxic heavy metal that are harmful for humans.

Keeping in view the mentioned scenario, Janhit Foundation conducted a few medical camp at Jaibheem Nagar wherein a team of reputed senior doctors from Subharti Medical College, Meerut visited the slum for medical check up. Free medicines were also provided to the patients after check up.

School dress sponsorship

A slum community is located near the office premises of Janhit Foundation in the Shastri Nagar locality. A few children living in the slum go to school while others help their parents in daily household activities because of their poor economic conditions.

Janhit Foundation sponsored school dress for five children of the slum enabling them to go to school. These children were not willing to go to their schools as they were daily scolded by their teachers for not wearing proper school uniform and felt ashamed of being reminded everyday for it in front of their other friends.

All the five children are now happy studying at their schools and feel comfortable joining the other children at the school who come from a comparatively good family background.

Woolen donation

Every year, the local media of Meerut reports deaths of old people in winters, living on the footpaths and public places as they do not have proper shelter. They do not have sufficient woollens to protect themselves from this natural but often ignored problem.

Through this grant support, Janhit Foundation distributed woollens to 20 needy people with no proper clothing to protect themselves. The distribution was done at three different locations.

Promotion of safe sanitation and water hygiene practices

100 women and girls living in the slum communities of Meerut were educated on 'Water and sanitation cleanliness' by Janhit Foundation. An interactive discussion was organized with the community in order to create a better impact on their minds.

A hygiene kit including soap, band-aid, toothbrushes, washcloths, hand towels, combs, and nail clippers were also distributed to 80 families of the slum.

Training on on-farm manure and bio-pesticide production

100 farmers of Rohta block were provided with practical training on producing organic manures and bio-pesticides on their own farms using locally available material.

Resource people were invited who gave a presentation on the subject and were given practical demonstration on the preparations. The farmers have benefitted a lot from the trainings as they were totally dependent on non-organic inputs for their crops which were bought from the markets and posed a great economic burden on their pockets, increasing their cost of production. The farmers who are now using organic inputs have also witnessed a better yield along with net profits.



Dual Honour for Green Cause

Adding further glory to the name of Janhit Foundation, Ms. Anita Rana, Director Janhit Foundation, Meerut was selected along with four other women to receive an Award for her exemplary work in the field of sustainable livelihoods & environmental practices on 1st Feb 2012. Ms. Anita was chosen to receive this award by the EDN (Earth Day Network) & the Global Environment facility (GEF)/ United Nations Development Programme (UNDP). She was presented with 2 awards, the first – an award recognizing “Leadership in Community Initiatives for a Green Economy” from the UNDP which was presented to her by the UNDP country director, Caitlin Wiesen and the second certificate of appreciation was awarded by the EDN for her “Valuable work in support of Earth Day Network’s Campaign- Women and the Green Economy (WAGE)”.



Arriving in Meerut in the latter half of 2011, I have now (heat asides) acclimatized to live in North India. Working with a non-profit organization out here can be an unrelenting occupation, with many hurdles and obstacles to overcome on a daily basis.

After many months of familiarizing myself with the ins and outs of Janhit Foundation’s activities and working alongside project staff on a variety of community based programmes, I have now developed a specific focus for my final few months in India. With an academic background, in Flood Risk Management, I have been looking for an opportunity to implement these skills on the ground here in Western Uttar Pradesh.

In the Hastinapur region of Meerut district, the Ganga River bursts its banks and floods the surrounding area on an annual basis during monsoon season. Consequently, I am now in the process of designing a community management flood project which aims to recreate a concept of risk reduction which has been used on a large scale in Bangladesh. It is this project for which I would most like to see funding secured, before I leave India and return to the UK. Watch this space....

- Duncan Craig, Volunteer from UK

World Water Forum—Marseille

The 6th World Water Forum took place in Marseille, France, from March 12th to 17th, 2012 and Duncan Craig, attended on behalf of Janhit Foundation.

The conference was attended by more than 20,000 people from over 170 countries, representing governments, parliaments, regional and local authorities, international organizations, companies and public and private research institutions and civil society.

The Forum was very much a political affair, drawing together countries and governments from around the globe to discuss water related issues. The majority of thematic work-

shops focused on international trans-boundary water management, which is perceived to be a key weakness in global water resource management to date.

The emphasis was very much on building consensus with nations focusing on finding simple points which they could agree on in the public domain and which could be taken forward in the future, in terms of policy development. This resulted in the compilation of the Forum’s ministerial statement, which stressed the need to speed up the implementation of the human right to safe drinking water and sanitation. In addition to this,

twelve ministerial round tables were convened, with the aim of finding recommendations related to issues like trans-boundary water management, water and green growth, waste water management, energy and food security. These commitments and recommendations will be put forward by the World Water Council in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil in June 2012, at the United Nations Conference on Sustainable Development (Rio+20).



Drawing Competition at Big Bazaar

On 27th March 2012, Meerut CHILDLINE in association with Big-Bazaar team (Store Incharge Mr.Nitin Das) organized a Drawing competition for Slum children at Big-Bazaar outlet in PVS Mall.

Around 35 children participated in this activity. The theme for this Drawing competition was Water Conservation. In this activity, children drew out their ideas on different ways to save water. Some slogans like, "Save water save life", "Water is life" were given by children for their beautiful drawings. All the children were divided in 2 groups out of which Chetan, Van-shika, Varun, Monu, Rahul & Sonu were awarded with prizes. In this program, Ms.Ruchira, Ms.Archana & Janhit Foundation's Director Ms.Anita Rana were the judges for this activity.

Presentation at CCS University

A seminar on environment conservation and water was organized by the Environment Department of CCS University from March 24-26, 2012. It was participated in by a number of students, researchers, NGOs etc. Janhit Foundation was invited for a presentation on its study conducted for Jaibheem Nagar on Human and Environmental Crisis. Alongwith a power-point presentation, a documentary on the efforts of Janhit Foundation at Jaibheem Nagar was also screened which was much appreciated by the participants.

Water Literacy Project

'Spreading Water Literacy on Wheels' being run by Janhit Foundation in support with the ADOBE & CAF is a project aimed at making children aware about the use and conservation of water by various methods like Water testing in their schools, showing documentary for awareness regarding water crisis/pollution & other water related problems. The focus is on spreading awareness amongst students of standard VI to VIII. Taking a step further in this direction, on 4th Feb 2012. Janhit Foundation organized an awareness program in some schools of Noida like Noida Public school, Lord Mahaveera etc. Drawing & Painting competition, Essay Writing & Debate Competition was held.

Bhoomi Poojan at Kutte Ka Talaab

'Kutte ka Talaab' is situated in Ghaziabad district approximately 1 km from the Lalkaun locality in the village Chipiyana. As legend has it, the pond was historically the tomb of a faithful dog who was mistakenly killed by his master. The pond derives its name from the fact that many people take a dip in the water after having been bitten by a dog. After immersing themselves in the water, the people pay obeisance to the idol of the dog and feel relieved of all physical pain and mental trauma. This folklore is also paid tribute to in the book 'Swadhinta Andolan aur Meerut' written by Acharya Deepankar (Professor of Lacs of Rupees), with records providing evidence of it dating back to the times of Nal and Damyanti.

In the Mughal period, this area was the property of Sayyeds who were courtesans of the King of Delhi. The area was divided into two distinct areas; Nariwala and Naragarhi. The inhabitants of each were fierce enemies and around the year 1750, a small battle took place, following which the area was left abandoned. The arms and ammunitions were thrown in the well which became embedded in the soil as decades passed, during which time the legend and folklore began to

generate pace.

Janhit Foundation in association with Coca Cola India Beverages Pvt. Ltd. and Charities Aid Foundation has taken up the responsibility of reviving this pond and thus keeping the history of this pond living and the legend alive. To this end, an inauguration ceremony of the project was organized at the pond on April 4, 2012. The ceremony involved the participation of Janhit's team, representatives from Coca Cola, CAF, and the local administra-

tion, the Pradhan of the region and residents of Chipiyana village. During the opening speech, Ms. Anita Rana welcomed all the guests and participants and shared the work being undertaken by Janhit Foundation on water conservation. She also briefed the gathering about this important project and the activities which would be undertaken in order to restore the pond to its former glory. Mr. Prateek Dubey on behalf of Coca Cola also gave a briefing on similar initiatives being undertaken by his agency. Also present were the Village head Mr. Ravindra Chaudhary, Block Head Mr. Amrish

Bhati and the District President of Gautambudh Nagar Sh. Fakeerchand Nagar and they all showed a keen interest in supporting Jan-



hit Foundation in this project.

Charities Aid Foundation was represented by Akriti Manchanda and Manu Sharma and, after, a Bhoomi Pujan, towards the end of the programme Janhit Foundation appealed to the local villagers to extend their support and assistance to this project. In addition to this, it was emphasized that the villagers must play a significant role in maintaining the pond once the project was completed, to which they agreed.

13th CHILDLINE National Partnership Director's Meet

Celebrating the success of completing 15 years of CHILDLINE service at 182 locations, a National partnership Meet was organized at United Service Institution, Rao Tula Ram Marg, New Delhi on 3rd & 4th Jan 2012. Ms. Anita Rana Director, Meerut CHILDLINE attended this 2 day meet. The program began with a welcome address by Mr. Nawshir Mirza, Trustee CIF, addressed by Dr. Dinesh Paul, Director NIPCCD, Ms. Neela Gangadharan Chief guest Secretary, MWCD. The key issues that were discussed during the meet were Political Economy & Child Rights, Emerging areas for child protection, Launch of National study of protection mechanism, Dialogue on safe spaces for children and concluded with Vote of Thanks by Ms. Chitrakala Acharya, Head services CIF.

Farmer's Training on Setting up of Seed Bank for Improved access to Quality seeds

A one day training programme was organized by Janhit Foundation, Meerut supported by Oxfam India, New Delhi on "Setting up of Seed Bank for Improved access to Quality seeds" for farmers of Khaspur, Pooth, Narangpur, Saifpur, Nanglamal & Maou Khas. The project coordinator, Mr.Devpal Singh explained the importance of the Seed certification to the farmers. He explained to the farmers that, due to ever increasing production cost & extremely expensive seeds, their Net profit is usually negligible. Therefore, with the help of Seed certification, farmers can get a better livelihood & enhance their income as well. Mr.Ravinder Kumar & Rohit Kumar explained the farmers, the procedure of setting up a seed bank for the improved quality seed. Following it, a farmer can produce a certified seed which will earn him a good amount of profit.



In October I arrived in India from the UK, where I work for HSBC Bank to spend five weeks working with Janhit Foundation.

During my time with Janhit I found myself heavily involved in their ongoing work across the fields of sustainable agriculture, water conservation and child rights. These initiatives lead me to assist with organic training days, Meerut CHILDLINE day, and present an overview of the voluntary sector at a local school. Alongside these community events I spent the majority of my time writing and designing further projects to enable the organization to further their goal of achieving sustainable development for the local communities across the spheres of life.

I found my time at Janhit to be thoroughly rewarding experience, and hope that the work I completed during this period helps the organization to continue the valuable work they complete in the local communities.

-Mathew Bell, Volunteer from UK

Study of the Nanglamal Area Water Pollution

Water Pollution is one of the main problems engulfing the people of India. The economy is booming but with more industries comes more industrial wastes, deforestation, air pollution and other practices which need to be checked and restricted. Nanglamal, a village in Western U.P is a perfect example of a victim of environmental hazards caused by the industrial wastes. Nanglamal Sugar mill is seen to have been causing such pollution which in turn has contaminated the ground water of the village and areas nearby.

As a part of this project, a village wide survey was conducted by a team of 3 people from the Janhit Foundation, Meerut. The methodology followed while conducting the survey was: Personal interviews, Questionnaire, Water Sample Testing. A survey was carried out for 333 families consisting of 2536 people. This covers almost 90% of the residents of the village. After the questionnaire and interviews were completed, water sample testing was done. 14 water samples were tested from different parts of the village within a radius of 1.5km. Samples were taken from hand pumps used regularly by village people to maintain relevance and genuineness.

Learnings from the project:

1. The people of Nanglamal are living in adverse unhygienic conditions and are a serious victim of ground water contamination.
2. The Nanglamal village clean ground water table has reduced to below 120 feet.
3. The Nanglamal Sugar mill is considered as one of the best sugar mills in India, but the careless practices followed by the mill related to its waste disposal is causing contamination of ground water.
4. The air pollution in Nanglamal due to the mill is also acting as a catalyst in creating health problems for the people
5. A significant portion of the income of Nanglamal people is spent per month as monthly medical expenses.
6. The life expectancy of Nanglamal has reduced below 60 years over the last 4-5 years.
7. The lack of awareness among the residents of Nanglamal related to the cause of diseases and their hazardous consequences has led to serious issues.

Update from Meerut CHILDLINE

Taking an initiative towards concrete work in CHILD Rights, Meerut CHILDLINE started forming BAL Panchayats (Child Groups) with the children of Slum areas of Nangla Tashi- Kankerkhara, Tejgarhi, Paawli Khaas- Modipuram, Kaseru Baksar-Ganganagar & Madhavpuram, Meerut. A group of children was formed from the particular area & they were informed about CHILDLINE 1098 & its working areas. They all were made aware about CHILD RIGHTS. Some of the school going children out of them were appointed as Heads/Bal Panch & Secretary of their area. These children will call at 1098 & will make CHILDLINE aware if they find any child involved in Begging or Child Labor or any case related to a missing child, Medical problem, child abuse or any education related problem.

Janhit at Delhi Haat

Janhit Foundation has been associated with the Centre of Environmental Education (CEE) for the past few years and has organized various activities in collaboration to promote environmental awareness.

Janhit participated in a programme organized by CEE at Dilli Haat from June 1-5, 2011. Janhit put up a stall displaying organic products. Dilli Haat being one of the most popular places specially known for the variety of handicraft goods attracts many tourists. The stall put up by Janhit grabbed the attention of many. The visitors were informed about the benefits of consuming organic products. The stall received a lot of appreciation from everyone. Janhit also earned the proud privilege of celebrating the World Environment Day (June 5) with the Ministry of Environment and Forests, Govt. of India.

Bal Panchayat at Meerut

Taking an initiative towards concrete work in CHILD Rights, Meerut CHILDLINE started forming BAL Panchayats (Child Groups) with the children of sum areas. They all were made aware about CHILD RIGHTS. From amongst the school going children, a few were selected as Heads/Bal Panch & Secretary of their area. These children will call at 1098 & will make CHILDLINE aware if they find any child in distress.

UGC Grant Conference

The UGC grant conference in Baraut on 'Water depletion and its effects on the environment' provided a platform for highlighting the urgent need of the hour. The conference took place at JAT COLLEGE, Baraut and was attended by distinguished personalities lending credibility to the whole issue.

The JANHIT FOUNDATION team was present and Mr. Duncan Craig presented a paper on the need to integrate all the measures carried out to tackle the issue of water management. His presentation was greeted with a lot of interest by the panel members and other dignitaries and it also showcased the need to consider water bodies as one entity thus creating a platform for positive discussion.

The event brought together experts from different disciplines such as Senior Scientists from IRI, Delhi to the representative of the Ministry of Culture. The efforts of JANHIT in the field of water conservation were recognized by the panelists and Ms. Anita Rana, Director of JANHIT FOUNDATION was felicitated and lauded for the work that the foundation carries out.

The message was conveyed loud and clear that the issue at hand required a concentrated effort by the government and other agencies. The conference aimed at spreading awareness was a resounding success and the JANHIT team felt they had achieved what they had in mind in terms of the message going through to the people.

Anil Agarwal Dialogue on green clearances

Janhit Foundation was invited to participate in the Anil Agarwal Dialogue on green clearances which was organised by the Centre for Science and Environment (CSE) in New Delhi on February 24-25, 2012. On one hand, there is a general perception in the business and industry that environmental and forest clearances are hampering economic development by delaying projects. On the other hand, the local communities and NGOs believe that these green clearances are not working for people and environment. The Anil Agarwal Dialogue aimed to bring all stakeholders together to discuss and debate various issues related to environmental and forest clearances in the country. The idea was also to devise a way ahead to ensure that the green clearances meet their real objectives of protecting the environment and ushering sustainable development in the country. The first day of the Dialogue was an NGO conclave to discuss and bring together the various issues from across the country. An open public meeting was organised on the second day participated by representatives of Ministry of Environment and Forests, Planning Commission, civil society and industry to discuss the issues.

Toxic Chemicals Management: Availing Opportunities Under Stockholm Convention

The Stockholm Convention (2001 / 2004) is an important global treaty to protect human health and environment from the Persistent Organic Pollutants (POPs). India is a signatory to this Convention (Signed May 14, 2002; ratified on January 13, 2006). The treaty finally came into force on 12 April 2006. Including India, the convention has 151 signatory countries.

In August 2010, the nine new POPs which were added to the Convention are of very different nature. Flame retardants are the trickiest ones to deal with. Moreover, there is not much India specific information that is available on these new POPs. The National Implementation Plan that was submitted by India in April 2011 brought some new information regarding 'Dirty Dozen'. However, the independent evaluation of this report by UNIDO suggests glaring gaps in NIP and its future process of implantation such as, inventory, research and financing mechanism. This needs to be discussed by the stakeholders.

In the above backdrop Toxics Link, New Delhi invited Janhit Foundation to participate in this important conference with an aim to provide a platform to find opportunities for collective effort in identifying solutions and helping draw up a roadmap for sound chemicals management in the country in line with the Convention and the NIP. The objectives the conference were to –

Initiate dialogue process on POPs and opportunities under Stockholm Convention with key stakeholders in India Discuss India's NIP on POPs and the future roadmap, including our action plan on New POPs Have critical dialogue on outstanding concerns on POPs – such as inventory, research agenda and financing mechanism.